From Boring to Amazing

The 5-tool stack for turning a plain Claude-built site into a modern, polished one.

Setup guide by @woke_engineer — companion to the reel

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1 Frontend Design Skill — SKILL

Anthropic's own skill for breaking the “Inter font + purple gradient” AI look. It pushes Claude to commit to a real aesthetic direction (typography, color, layout, motion) instead of defaulting to generic patterns, before it writes a line of code.

Install (pick one):

```
# Option A — Claude Code plugin marketplace

/plugin marketplace add anthropics/claude-code

/plugin install frontend-design@claude-code-plugins


# Option B — skills CLI, current project only

npx -y skills add anthropics/skills --skill frontend-design --agent claude-code
```

Once installed it auto-activates whenever you ask Claude to build a UI — no slash command needed.

2 shadcn MCP — MCP SERVER

Gives Claude live access to the shadcn/ui component registry — it can browse, search, and install real components and blocks (buttons, forms, dashboards) instead of hallucinating markup.

Install in Claude Code:

```
npx shadcn@latest mcp init --client claude
```

Then restart Claude Code and check it connected:

```
/mcp
```

Try it: “Add a pricing section using the shadcn registry.”

3 Figma MCP — MCP SERVER

Lets Claude read structured design context straight from a Figma file — components, variables, layout, spacing — so generated code actually matches the mockup instead of a text description of it. Needs a Figma Dev or Full seat.

Step 1 — enable the server in Figma:

- Open a Figma Design file in the desktop app or browser
- With nothing selected, switch the canvas to **Dev Mode**
- In the right-hand panel, click “Set up an MCP client” (or enable the local MCP server from Figma → Preferences)

Step 2 — connect Claude Code (remote server, recommended):

```
claude mcp add --transport http figma-remote-mcp https://mcp.figma.com/mcp
```

Restart Claude Code, run **/mcp**, select figma-remote-mcp, and authenticate in the browser.

4 Playwright MCP — MCP SERVER

Gives Claude a real browser it can drive — navigate, click, screenshot, read the accessibility tree. Use it to have Claude actually look at the site it just built and fix what looks wrong. Requires Node.js 18+.

Install in Claude Code:

```
claude mcp add playwright npx @playwright/mcp@latest
```

*Verify with **/mcp** (or **claude mcp list**), then try: "Use playwright mcp to open the site and screenshot the homepage."*

5 design.md — PROJECT FILE

A one-page design brief you drop in your project root — the design equivalent of a CLAUDE.md. It pins down the decisions you don't want Claude re-guessing on every prompt, so the site stays consistent across pages and sessions.

What to put in it:

- **Aesthetic direction** — e.g. "brutalist minimalism" or "warm editorial, not corporate SaaS"
- **Type & color** — font pairing and the exact palette / CSS variables to reuse
- **Layout rules** — spacing scale, grid, what NOT to do (no purple gradients, no Inter-everywhere)
- **Reference links** — sites or Figma frames that capture the vibe you want

Create it once, then just say:

```
Follow design.md for all styling decisions on this project.
```

Stack it end to end: **design.md** sets the direction → **frontend-design skill** enforces taste → **Figma MCP** pulls the real design → **shadcn MCP** supplies production components → **Playwright MCP** lets Claude check its own work in a browser.